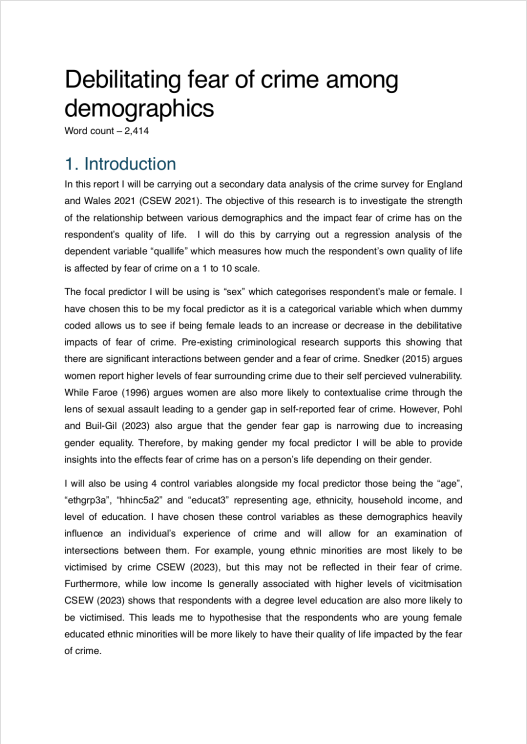
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Debilitating fear of crime among demographics

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1. Introduction

In this report I will be carrying out a secondary data analysis of the crime survey for England and Wales 2021 (CSEW 2021). The objective of this research is to investigate the strength of the relationship between various demographics and the impact fear of crime has on the respondent's quality of life. I will do this by carrying out a regression analysis of the dependent variable "quallife" which measures how much the respondent's own quality of life is affected by fear of crime on a 1 to 10 scale.

The focal predictor I will be using is "sex" which categorises respondent's male or female. I have chosen this to be my focal predictor as it is a categorical variable which when dummy coded allows us to see if being female leads to an increase or decrease in the debilitative impacts of fear of crime. Pre-existing criminological research supports this showing that there are significant interactions between gender and a fear of crime. Snedker (2015) argues women report higher levels of fear surrounding crime due to their self percieved vulnerability. While Faroe (1996) argues women are also more likely to contextualise crime through the lens of sexual assault leading to a gender gap in self-reported fear of crime. However, Pohl and Buil-Gil (2023) also argue that the gender fear gap is narrowing due to increasing gender equality. Therefore, by making gender my focal predictor I will be able to provide insights into the effects fear of crime has on a person's life depending on their gender.

I will also be using 4 control variables alongside my focal predictor those being the "age", "ethgrp3a", "hhinc5a2" and "educat3" representing age, ethnicity, household income, and level of education. I have chosen these control variables as these demographics heavily influence an individual's experience of crime and will allow for an examination of intersections between them. For example, young ethnic minorities are most likely to be victimised by crime CSEW (2023), but this may not be reflected in their fear of crime. Furthermore, while low income Is generally associated with higher levels of vicitmisation CSEW (2023) shows that respondents with a degree level education are also more likely to be victimised. This leads me to hypothesise that the respondents who are young female educated ethnic minorities will be more likely to have their quality of life impacted by the fear of crime.

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